

**DATASTREAM**

Comparing the Carbon Footprint of Transportation Options



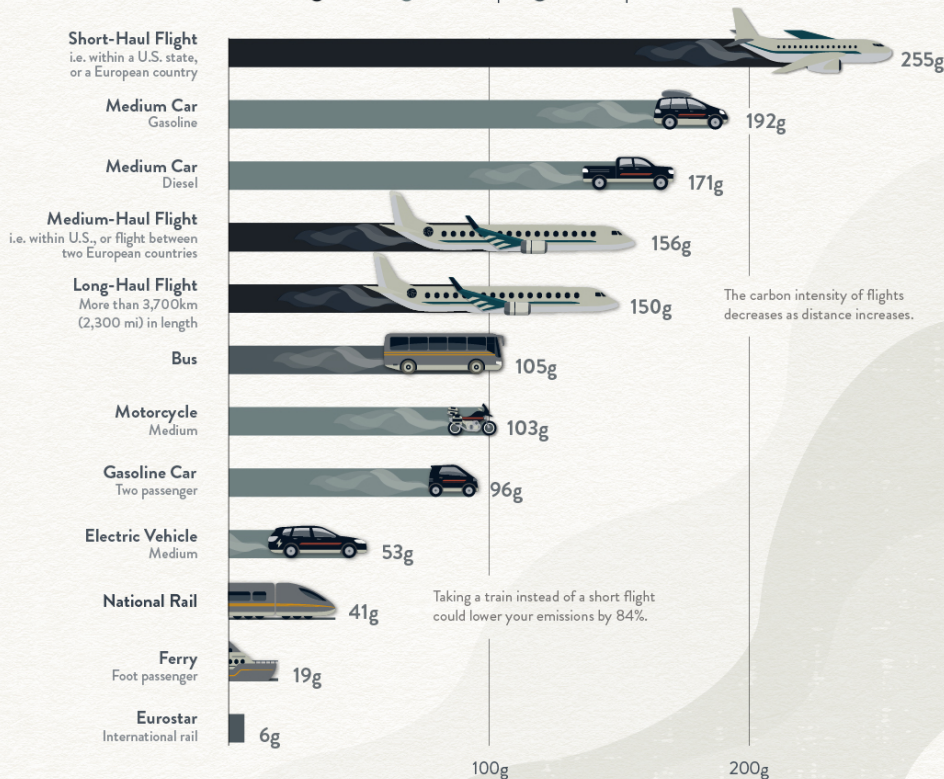
Published February 15, 2022 12:13 pm

By **Govind Bhutada** Editing **Harrison Schell** Design **Rosey Eason**

The Carbon Cost of Transportation

What's the lowest-carbon method of transportation? Here's the carbon footprint of travel for different vehicles, measured in grams of carbon dioxide equivalents per passenger-kilometer.

● Air Travel ● Private Transport ● Public Transport



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The Briefing

- Flying domestically and driving alone are the most carbon-intensive travel methods
- Taking a train instead of a short flight could reduce your emissions by 84%

The Carbon Footprint of Transportation

As concern about climate change has grown, individuals are becoming increasingly conscious of their impact on the environment.

Transportation emissions often make up the largest portion of our individual carbon footprints. For that reason, evaluating transport options is a natural place to start, whether it is for a daily commute or a leisure trip abroad.

So, what’s the most eco-friendly way to go from one place to another?

The above infographic charts the carbon footprint of transportation per passenger-kilometer for different vehicles based on data from the UK Government’s [methodology paper](#) for greenhouse gas reporting.

Editor’s note: Because the original labels in the study are very UK-specific, we have changed the copy of some of the labels to better suit an international audience.

Planes, Trains and Automobiles: How Carbon Footprints Compare

The carbon footprint of transportation is measured in grams of carbon dioxide (CO₂) equivalents emitted per person to travel one kilometer. This includes both carbon dioxide and other [greenhouse gases](#).

Here’s how the carbon cost of travel compares for different means of transport:

Means of Transport	CO ₂ equivalent emissions per passenger km
Short Flight ✈️	255g
Medium Car (Gasoline) 🚗	192g
Medium Car (Diesel) 🚗	171g
Medium Flight ✈️	156g
Long Flight ✈️	150g
Bus 🚌	105g
Medium Motorcycle 🏍️	103g
Gasoline Car (Two Passenger) 🚗	96g
Medium Electric Vehicle 🚗	53g
National Rail 🚆	41g
Ferry 🚢	19g
Eurostar (International Rail) 🚆	6g

Flying on a short flight or driving alone are the most carbon-intensive travel methods. However, adding one more passenger to your car ends up cutting the [emissions](#) in half, making driving more efficient.

Specifically, it’s worth breaking down categories of flights more, as their emissions depend greatly on their route length:

- **Short Flights:** For example, domestic flights within a European country, or flights within a U.S. state have the highest individual carbon footprint.
- **Medium Flights:** For example, international travel within Europe, or between U.S. states, have a significantly lower carbon footprint per person.
- **Long Flights:** Flights over 3,700 km (2,300 mi), about the distance from Los Angeles to New York, have the lowest carbon footprint per person.

Why are longer flights far more eco-friendly than short-range flights? It’s because take-off uses much more energy than the ‘cruise’ phase of a flight. For short flights, the efficient cruise phase is relatively short-lived.

Shrinking Your Travel Footprint

As the world works to mitigate the impact of climate change, people may want to identify and potentially reduce their daily carbon footprint. And choosing your method of transportation is one way to do so.

Of course, walking, biking, or running are the lowest-carbon ways to go from one place to another. But car-sharing can also reduce emissions, as can switching to [electric vehicles](#) or public transport.

Over medium-to-long distances, trains are the most eco-friendly option, and for short-range domestic travel, driving is better than taking a flight. But as some countries are bigger than others, always consider the total distance you need to travel, and the breadth of options you have available.

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Where does this data come from?

Source: [UK Department for Business, Energy & Industrial Strategy](#), [Our World in Data](#)

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Charting the Rise of Cross-Border Money Transfers (2015-2023)

With over 280 million immigrants transferring billions of dollars annually, the remittance industry has become more valuable than ever.



Published June 21, 2023 11:04 am

By **Alan Kennedy**

The Briefing

- 79% of remittance payments in 2022 were made to low and middle-income countries.
- Borderless, low-cost money transfer services like those provided by Wise can help immigrants support their families.

The Rise of Cross-Border Money Transfers

The remittance industry has experienced consistent growth recently, solidifying its position as a key component of the global financial landscape. Defined as the transfer of money from one country to another, usually to support a dependent, remittances play a pivotal role in providing financial support to families and communities.

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Can You Calculate Your Daily Carbon Footprint?

Discover how the average person's carbon footprint impacts the environment and learn how carbon credits can offset your carbon footprint.



Published June 20, 2023 5:33 am

By **Alan Kennedy**

The Briefing

- A person's carbon footprint is substantial, with activities such as food consumption creating as much as 4,500 g of CO₂ emissions daily.
- By purchasing carbon credits from Carbon Streaming Corporation, you can offset your own emissions and fund positive climate action.

Your Everyday Carbon Footprint

While many large businesses and countries have committed to net-zero goals, it is essential to acknowledge that your everyday activities also contribute to global emissions.

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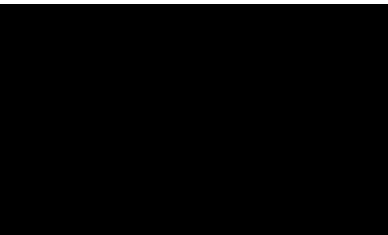
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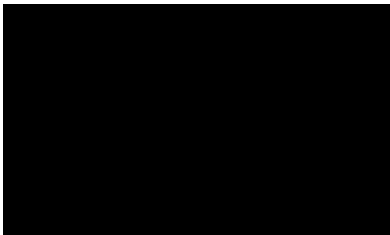
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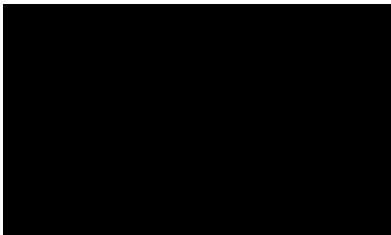
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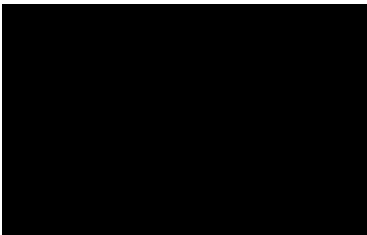
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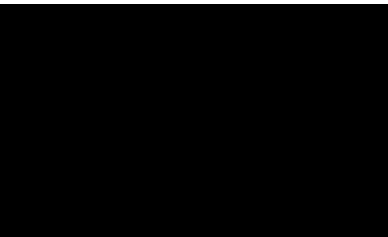
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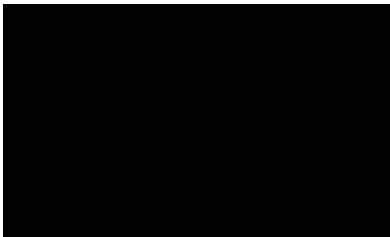
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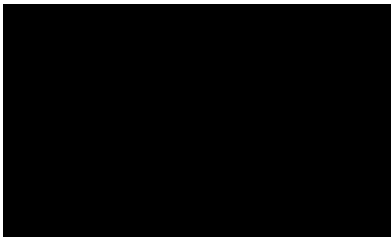
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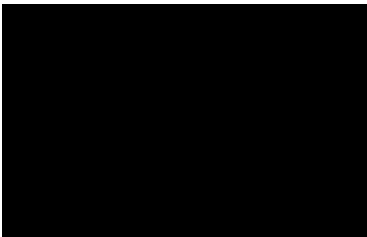
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